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<http://dgit.in/Nv15m>

Q&A

It freezes for a long time and then it suddenly blacks out. To revive it, I need to take the battery out, cool it and then put the battery back in. The problem repeats after an hour or earlier. Sometimes it works for an hour if it has not been used for three or four days but if run continuously then half an hour is the maximum that it'll work for before it conks off again. I used original Windows 7 Home Basic 64 bit, then Windows 7 Ultimate and now Windows 10 Pro. Could this be a problem of the hard drives? If so can I replace it with an SSD? How much would it cost to repair this laptop?

—Dominic M Sangma

A Since you've switched between multiple operating systems, we're going to rule that out. We're assuming that you had the proper drivers installed so it comes down to whatever other software you've installed, or the problem might stem from your hardware. We mentioned software because there are plenty of game profile managers which try to overlay their own OSD onto full screen programs and that sometimes causes programs to crash. The most obvious culprits behind your problem would be the hard drive or heating. Swap the hard drive out and put it into your PC and run a disk diagnostic software like HDTune to look for bad sectors. While this is going on, run a live USB Linux distro on your laptop and run a few exhaustive programs, all while running a temperature monitoring software. If you notice excessively high temperatures then you need to check the



Unclog the heatsinks

cooling vents on your laptop for dust clogs. Also, you might want to reseal the processor heatsink as well. All of this shouldn't cost more than ₹500. As for replacing your HDD with an SSD, yes you can do so if your HDD uses a SATA interface, however, for the same amount of money you'll not get a lot of storage

space if you get an SSD instead. However, your OS boot time and general responsiveness will improve considerably.

Pink display

Dear team Digit, Firstly, I'd like to say that I love Digit! It has brought me on a long journey from a fiction reader to a tech reader. Coming to my problem, for the last two days, my laptop screen has turned pink with vertical lines at irregular intervals. Though I called the customer service center, their response wasn't satisfactory. My system configurations are as follows: Model: HP Pavilion G6 2301ax, 500gb hard disk, 2.5gb graphics, 4GB DDR 3 RAM, Windows 8 OS. The customer service notified



Replace your display cable

me of a possible hardware issue. And for a guy who likes tinkering with his laptop, I couldn't place my finger on that. Please clarify what steps I should be taking and the possible expenses to be expected.

—Anita Liqueorvala

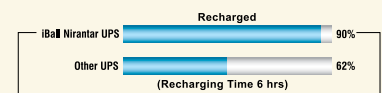
A This is a hardware issue. If you're seeing just discolouration and not visual artifacts then the problem is a loose connector or the FRC (Flat Ribbon Cable) that goes from your laptop's motherboard into the display panel has developed a slight crease or kink. Simply search eBay for a replacement laptop display cable for your Pavilion G6 and you should find plenty of units available for sale starting from about ₹400. Download the service / disassembly manual from the company website for your laptop (make sure you get the model absolutely right) and check if the replacement cable shown online has the same number of pins and is of the same length as the one currently hooked up to your display. If so, buy and replace your display cable and your problem should be resolved. 



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